

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12418849
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Wahid; Ali et al.

Geographic limitation of Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection

Abstract

Systems and methods of geographically limiting a cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network include obtaining a location of the cellular gateway; determining whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location on a given cellular network; and performing an action including any of blocking, allowing, or partially allowing operation of the cellular gateway on the cellular network. The method can be implemented by a cloud service, and wherein the location is determined by one of the cellular gateway and a user device connected to the cellular gateway.

Inventors: Wahid; Ali (Atlanta, GA), Kalmanje; Arun (Palo Alto, CA), Hotchkiss; Adam R. (Richardson, TX), McFarland; William J. (Portola Valley, CA)

Applicant: Plume Design, Inc. (Palo Alto, CA)

Family ID: 1000008818445

Assignee: PLUME DESIGN, INC. (Palo Alto, CA)

Appl. No.: 17/892977

Filed: August 22, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240064610 A1	Feb. 22, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04W48/02 (20090101); H04W4/021 (20180101); H04W64/00 (20090101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04W48/02 (20130101); H04W4/021 (20130101); H04W64/003 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04W (4/02); H04W (4/021); H04W (48/02); H04W (4/029); H04W (48/04); H04W (48/08); H04W (64/003)

USPC: 370/329

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
7859560	12/2009	Issa	455/414.1	H04L 12/189
7945470	12/2010	Cohen	455/433	G06F 16/27
8000719	12/2010	Lambert	455/456.2	H04W 64/00
9927807	12/2017	Ganjoo	N/A	G08G 5/26
10178578	12/2018	McFarland et al.	N/A	N/A
10299405	12/2018	Chang et al.	N/A	N/A
10341193	12/2018	Rengarajan et al.	N/A	N/A
10431868	12/2018	Samardzija et al.	N/A	N/A
10431869	12/2018	Samardzija et al.	N/A	N/A
10433194	12/2018	McFarland et al.	N/A	N/A
10462929	12/2018	Su et al.	N/A	N/A
10554733	12/2019	Edara et al.	N/A	N/A
10687227	12/2019	Rusackas et al.	N/A	N/A
10777877	12/2019	Su et al.	N/A	N/A
11109244	12/2020	Rengarajan et al.	N/A	N/A
11398946	12/2021	Rengarajan et al.	N/A	N/A
2004/0003190	12/2003	Childs	711/163	H04L 63/104
2004/0203758	12/2003	Agarwal	455/433	H04W 8/04
2005/0124288	12/2004	Karmi	455/3.01	H04W 12/06
2006/0120351	12/2005	Rajagopalan	370/352	H04L 69/169
2006/0184795	12/2005	Doradla	713/167	H04W 12/06
2006/0268680	12/2005	Roberts	370/216	H04L 45/28
2007/0149172	12/2006	Dickinson	455/411	H04W 92/02
2009/0323632	12/2008	Nix	370/331	H04W 36/0033
2010/0125868	12/2009	Foladare	725/62	H04L 65/611
2010/0165957	12/2009	Hegde	455/422.1	H04W 88/10
2011/0321142	12/2010	Chiang	726/5	H04W 12/065
2014/0126410	12/2013	Agarwal	370/332	H04W 24/02
2014/0146744	12/2013	Maria	370/328	H04W 12/088
2014/0156599	12/2013	Quan	707/634	G06F 9/4856
2014/0328190	12/2013	Lord	370/252	H04W 24/08
2015/0281194	12/2014	Elliott	726/7	H04W 12/06
2015/0359024	12/2014	Charbit	370/329	H04W 4/70
2016/0080949	12/2015	Chandrasekhar	370/252	H04W 72/27
2016/0105762	12/2015	Singh	455/41.2	H04L 51/58
2016/0353326	12/2015	Novo Diaz	N/A	H04L 67/1036
2017/0188223	12/2016	Gundavelli	N/A	H04W 48/16
2017/0195883	12/2016	Kwok	N/A	H04W 4/14

2017/0272317	12/2016	Singla et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0272965	12/2016	Kumar et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0324817	12/2017	Kwok	N/A	H04W 72/542
2019/0014519	12/2018	Brown	N/A	H04W 36/16
2019/0090158	12/2018	Das	N/A	H04L 67/12
2019/0098556	12/2018	Johnson	N/A	H04W 48/02
2019/0149990	12/2018	Wang	370/329	H04W 12/0471
2019/0171259	12/2018	McFarland et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0191305	12/2018	Dowlatkah	N/A	H04W 76/10
2019/0199725	12/2018	Pularikkal	N/A	H04L 63/10
2020/0160622	12/2019	Aquila	N/A	G01R 31/3835
2020/0162903	12/2019	Bhargava	N/A	H04L 63/164
2020/0288387	12/2019	Siddalinga	N/A	H04W 76/12
2020/0322805	12/2019	Wang	N/A	H04W 88/10
2020/0358196	12/2019	Samardzija et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0374683	12/2019	Cholas	N/A	H04W 8/06
2021/0029559	12/2020	Agarwal et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0105639	12/2020	McFarland	N/A	N/A
2021/0151875	12/2020	Samardzija et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0195441	12/2020	Agarwal et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0195442	12/2020	Agarwal et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0195443	12/2020	Agarwal et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0257733	12/2020	Samardzija et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0258792	12/2020	Rodriguez et al.	N/A	H04W 24/04
2021/0345219	12/2020	Watts, Jr.	N/A	H04W 88/16
2022/0102860	12/2021	Samardzija et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0132400	12/2021	Agarwal et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0141666	12/2021	Armerding	726/12	H04W 12/06
2022/0182826	12/2021	Gundavelli	N/A	H04W 12/086
2023/0379870	12/2022	Gorilovsky	N/A	H04W 4/80

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
3016072	12/2016	CA	N/A
3083495	12/2018	CA	N/A
3985939	12/2021	EP	N/A
2019213513	12/2018	WO	N/A
2019226428	12/2018	WO	N/A
2019236523	12/2018	WO	N/A
2021071627	12/2020	WO	N/A
2021092548	12/2020	WO	N/A

Primary Examiner: Gelin; Jean A

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Greenberg Traurig, LLP

Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) The present disclosure generally relates to wireless networking systems and methods. More particularly, the present disclosure relates to systems and methods for Wi-Fi networks with cellular connectivity, such as Wi-Fi network failover to cellular connection with throttling of traffic, installation of Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, Geographic limitation of Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, selecting and controlling base stations for Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, and frequency planning for Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection.

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

(2) Wi-Fi networks (i.e., wireless local area networks (WLAN) based on the IEEE 802.11 standards) are ubiquitous. In fact, Wi-Fi is the most common technique for user device connectivity, and the applications that run over Wi-Fi are continually expanding. For example, Wi-Fi is used to carry all sorts of media, including video traffic, audio traffic, telephone calls, video conferencing, online gaming, and security camera video. Often traditional data services are also simultaneously in use, such as web browsing, file upload/download, disk drive backups, and any number of mobile device applications. That is, Wi-Fi has become the primary connection between user devices and the Internet in the home or other locations. The vast majority of connected devices use Wi-Fi for their primary network connectivity. As such, there is a need to ensure applications run smoothly over Wi-Fi. There are various optimization techniques for adjusting network operating parameters such as described in commonly assigned U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/032,584, filed Jul. 11, 2018, and entitled "Optimization of distributed Wi-Fi networks," the contents of which are incorporated by reference herein.

(3) Wi-Fi is continuing to evolve with newer generations of technology, including IEEE 802.11a, 802.11b, 802.11g, 802.11n, 802.11ac, and 802.11ax (referred to as Wi-Fi 6/6E), and future Wi-Fi 7. Each generation of technology evolves the Wi-Fi Media Access Control (MAC) and Physical (PHY) layers to add more capabilities. In the case of IEEE 802.11 ax, orthogonal frequency-division multiple access (OFDMA) has been added as a technique aimed at improving the efficiency of Wi-Fi communication when many small packets are being transmitted to or from multiple client devices. OFDMA can operate both in the downlink (one access point communicating simultaneously to multiple clients), or in the uplink (multiple clients communicating simultaneously to a single access point).

(4) Traditionally, a Wi-Fi network includes at least one access point with a wired connection that connects to a gateway, such as a cable modem, a digital subscriber loop (DSL) modem, and the like, for connectivity to a wide area network (WAN), i.e., the Internet. However, fifth generation (5G) cellular deployments are proliferating. 5G offers an opportunity for high-speed wireless access to the WAN, providing various opportunities for service providers to offer fixed wireless access, backup for any cable modem or DSL connection, and the like. That is, future deployments will consider Wi-Fi access points with wireless WAN interfaces, such as via 5G.

(5) With the introduction of wireless WAN interfaces in Wi-Fi networks and access points, there are various areas to address.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(6) The present disclosure relates to systems and methods for Wi-Fi networks with cellular connectivity, such as Wi-Fi network failover to cellular connection with throttling of traffic, installation of Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, Geographic limitation of Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, selecting and controlling base stations for Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, and frequency planning for Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection.

Again, conventionally, Wi-Fi access points connect to a gateway device such as a cable modem, DSL modem, etc. The present disclosure contemplates the addition of a cellular connection, such as for a backup to a broadband connection, as a primary connection, and the like.

(7) Various, the present disclosure includes a method having steps, a cloud service implemented

on servers, clusters, or the like, with the cloud service configured to implement the steps, as instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium where the instructions, when executed, cause one or more processor to perform the steps.

(8) In an embodiment, the present disclosure includes Wi-Fi network failover to a cellular connection with throttling of traffic having steps of detecting an outage on wired connections for any of the plurality of Wi-Fi networks; determining the any of the plurality of Wi-Fi networks have switched to a cellular connection as a failover based on the outage; and determining whether to throttle traffic on any cellular connection based on the failover and instructing corresponding gateways accordingly. The traffic can be throttled based on any of specific applications and specific uses. The traffic can be throttled based on virtual or conceptual local networks that are operational in the plurality of Wi-Fi networks and that have different priorities. The determining whether to throttle traffic can be based on any of the outage and the failover being above a certain number of Wi-Fi networks. The determining whether to throttle traffic can be based on feedback from a cellular control plane to the cloud service. The determining whether to throttle traffic can be based on a subscription of associated users of the plurality of Wi-Fi networks. The steps can include steering the corresponding gateways to different base stations to limit a load on any given base station. The steps can include receiving information from the corresponding gateways related to the cellular connection including an identification of a corresponding base station. The steps can include receiving information from the corresponding gateways related to the cellular connection including an identification of visible base stations; and steering the corresponding gateways to different base stations. The traffic can be throttled based on assigning the traffic to different types of cellular connections including 4G or 5G. The steps can include receiving advertisements from the any of the plurality of Wi-Fi networks based on different cellular band capabilities; and instructing the corresponding gateways based on the different cellular band capabilities.

(9) In another embodiment, the present disclosure includes installing a cellular gateway in a Wi-Fi network via steps of obtaining a cellular gateway that is configured to provide cellular connectivity to the Internet for an associated Wi-Fi network; measuring a plurality of locations in a building for the Wi-Fi network; and receiving an indication based on the measuring, on a mobile device, for locating the cellular gateway in the building. The mobile device can execute at least one of a mobile application and a browser session and communicates with the cellular gateway via any of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi. The measuring can be performed by the mobile device configured as a sensor, such that a user physically moves the mobile device to the plurality of locations. The cellular connectivity of the cellular gateway and the mobile device can be on different frequency bands with a correction factor used to adjust a measurement by the mobile device to reflect a value for the cellular gateway. The cellular connectivity of the cellular gateway and the mobile device can be with a same network provider. The cellular connectivity of the cellular gateway and the mobile device can be with a different network provider, with the mobile device forced into a roaming mode. The cellular connectivity of the cellular gateway and the mobile device can be with a different network provider, and the steps can include replacing a subscriber identity module (SIM) from the cellular gateway into the mobile device, prior to the measuring. The measuring can be performed by an installation sensor device provided with the cellular gateway. The measuring can be performed by the cellular gateway with one of a portable power bank and a laptop connected thereto. The cellular gateway can further include wired connectivity to the Internet and the plurality of locations include ones in the building supporting the wired connectivity. The Wi-Fi network can include a plurality of access points with the cellular gateway connected to one access point and a wired gateway connected to a different access point. The steps can further include providing results of the measuring to a cloud service. The steps can further include utilizing the results by the cloud service for any of analytics, development of heuristics, and providing advice or guidance to users. The mobile device can execute one of a mobile application and a browser session, and wherein the indication can be provided via the one of the mobile application and the browser session. The

indication can be at least one of bars, a number, and/or a phrase.

(10) In a further embodiment, the present disclosure includes geographically limiting a cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network via steps of obtaining a location of the cellular gateway; determining whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location on a given cellular network; and performing an action including any of blocking, allowing, or partially allowing operation of the cellular gateway on the cellular network. The process can be implemented by a cloud service, and wherein the location is determined by one of the cellular gateway and a user device connected to the cellular gateway. The user device can be configured to provide the location to the cloud service via a separate network from the Wi-Fi network. The location can be determined via a user device connected to the cellular gateway with the user device having a global positioning satellite (GPS) antenna configured to determine the location, and wherein the user device includes one of an application and a browser configured to provide the location. The user device can connect to the cellular gateway via any of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi. The location can be determined by cellular infrastructure in the given cellular network. The location can be based on which cellular base station the cellular gateway is connected or based on triangulation via a plurality of cellular base stations. The action can be performed locally at the cellular gateway. The action can be performed in one of a cloud system and the given cellular network. Whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location can be based on planning by a network operator. The action can further include allowing temporarily and then blocking, providing a notification of a user of the Wi-Fi network, allowing temporarily and then disconnecting the cellular gateway, allowing temporarily and then only allowing the cellular gateway to communicate with a cloud service, and only allowing the cellular gateway to communicate with a cloud service.

(11) In a further embodiment, the present disclosure includes selecting and controlling base stations for connectivity to a cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network via steps of obtaining information related to a cellular infrastructure of a cellular network; determining a list of preferred cellular identifiers, each identifying a cell for connectivity with the cellular gateway, based on a plurality of factors; and providing the list of preferred cellular identifiers to the cellular gateway where the cellular gateway utilizes the list for wireless access to the cellular infrastructure. The steps can include periodically updating the list of preferred cellular identifiers and providing the list of preferred cellular identifiers to the cellular gateway, based on changes in any of the plurality of factors. The plurality of factors can include available bandwidth in the cellular infrastructure, network congestion, network performance, maintenance work on the cellular infrastructure, and network outages. The information can be obtained from one or more databases managed by a network operator of the cellular network. The obtaining can include triggering active probe tests by the cellular gateway including any of speed tests, latency measurements, jitter measurements, and packet loss measurements. The obtaining can include consolidating results of the active probe tests with results from other devices; and determining load on the cellular infrastructure based on the consolidated results. The steps can include, subsequent to the cellular gateway connecting to a preferred cell, causing modification of a connection between the cellular gateway and the preferred cell, for improvement of the connection. The modification can include any of changing signal strength, changing a buffer status report, changing a power headroom report, and changing multiple input multiple output of the cellular gateway. The modification can include any of manipulating quality of service (QoS) class identifier, manipulating statistics from the cellular gateway, and altering a capability report from the cellular gateway.

(12) In a further embodiment, the present disclosure includes a process of frequency planning for a cellular gateway in a Wi-Fi network via steps of connecting to cellular infrastructure at a cellular frequency; providing a Wi-Fi connection at a Wi-Fi frequency selected to coexist with the cellular frequency; and, responsive to interference between the cellular frequency and the Wi-Fi frequency, performing one or more actions to reduce the interference. The Wi-Fi frequency selected to coexist with the cellular frequency can be predetermined based on any of field measurements and lab

measurements. The Wi-Fi frequency selected to coexist with the cellular frequency can be determined based on a channel selection process with weighting factors on Wi-Fi frequencies that are based on how well they work with the cellular frequency. The cellular frequency can be fixed and the Wi-Fi frequency is selected based on the fixed cellular frequency. The one or more actions can include any of changing a transmit port over the Wi-Fi frequency and changing a modulation coding scheme of Wi-Fi signals over the Wi-Fi frequency. The one or more actions can include interacting with the cellular infrastructure to manipulate the cellular frequency. The one or more actions can include scheduling transmissions over the Wi-Fi frequency to avoid interference with the cellular frequency. The one or more actions can include manipulating listen before talk thresholds on the Wi-Fi frequency to defer transmissions over the Wi-Fi frequency when the cellular frequency is active. The Wi-Fi network can include the cellular gateway and one or more additional access points. The one or more additional access points can be configured to use request to send (RTS)/clear to send (CTS) to reduce the interference. Wi-Fi clients can be steered to the one or more additional access points from the cellular gateway.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The present disclosure is illustrated and described herein with reference to the various drawings, in which like reference numbers are used to denote like system components/method steps, as appropriate, and in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a network diagram of various Wi-Fi network topologies for connectivity to the Internet.
- (3) FIG. 2A is a network diagram of the Wi-Fi network with cloud-based control.
- (4) FIG. 2B is a network diagram of an example implementation of the Wi-Fi network, as a distributed Wi-Fi network in a tree topology.
- (5) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of functional components of the access points, mesh nodes, repeaters, etc., in the Wi-Fi networks of FIG. 1.
- (6) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of functional components of a server, a Wi-Fi client device, or a user device that may be used with the Wi-Fi network of FIG. 1 and/or the cloud-based control of FIG. 3.
- (7) FIG. 5 is a network diagram of a portion of a network associated with a network operator.
- (8) FIG. 6 is a diagram of a fixed wireless access system for wired and/or wireless connectivity.
- (9) FIG. 7 is a flowchart of a process for Wi-Fi network failover to cellular connection with throttling of traffic.
- (10) FIG. 8 is a diagram of a house with multiple locations to place the cellular gateway.
- (11) FIG. 9 is a flowchart of a process for installation of a cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network.
- (12) FIG. 10 is a flowchart of a process for geographically limiting a cellular gateway (“device”).
- (13) FIG. 11 is a flowchart of a process of geographically limiting a cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network.
- (14) FIG. 12 is a network diagram of a cellular gateway that is connected to the cloud service and able to connect to multiple base stations.
- (15) FIG. 13 is a diagram of active probe tests via the cloud service and the cellular gateway.
- (16) FIG. 14 is flowchart of a process for selecting and controlling base stations for the cellular gateway.
- (17) FIG. 15 is a flowchart of a process for frequency planning for a cellular gateway in a Wi-Fi network.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DISCLOSURE

- (18) Again, the present disclosure relates to systems and methods for Wi-Fi networks with cellular connectivity, such as Wi-Fi network failover to cellular connection with throttling of traffic,

installation of Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, Geographic limitation of Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, selecting and controlling base stations for Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection, and frequency planning for Wi-Fi access points with cellular connection. Again, conventionally, Wi-Fi access points connect to a gateway device such as a cable modem, DSL modem, etc. The present disclosure contemplates the addition of a cellular connection, such as for a backup to a broadband connection, as a primary connection, and the like.

§ 1.0 Wi-Fi Network Topologies

(19) FIG. 1 is a network diagram of various Wi-Fi network **10** (namely Wi-Fi networks **10A-10D**) topologies for connectivity to the Internet **12**. The Wi-Fi network **10** can operate in accordance with the IEEE 802.11 protocols and variations thereof. The Wi-Fi network **10** is deployed to provide coverage in a physical location, e.g., home, business, store, library, school, park, etc. The differences in the topologies of the Wi-Fi networks **10** are that they provide different scope of physical coverage. As described herein and as known in the art, the Wi-Fi network **10** can be referred to as a network, a system, a Wi-Fi network, a Wi-Fi system, a cloud-based Wi-Fi system, etc. The access points **14** and equivalent (i.e., mesh nodes **18**, repeater **20**, and devices **22**) can be referred to as nodes, access points, Wi-Fi nodes, Wi-Fi access points, etc. The objective of the nodes is to provide network connectivity to Wi-Fi client devices **16** which can be referred to as client devices, user equipment, user devices, clients, Wi-Fi clients, Wi-Fi devices, etc. Note, those skilled in the art will recognize the Wi-Fi client devices **16** can be mobile devices, tablets, computers, consumer electronics, home entertainment devices, televisions, Internet of Things (IoT) devices, or any network-enabled device.

(20) The Wi-Fi network **10A** includes a single access point **14**, which can be a single, high-powered access point **14**, which may be centrally located to serve all Wi-Fi client devices **16** in a location. Of course, a typical location can have several walls, floors, etc. between the single access point **14** and the Wi-Fi client devices **16**. Plus, the single access point **14** operates on a single channel (or possible multiple channels with multiple radios), leading to potential interference from neighboring systems. The Wi-Fi network **10B** is a Wi-Fi mesh network that solves some of the issues with the single access point **14** by having multiple mesh nodes **18**, which distribute the Wi-Fi coverage. Specifically, the Wi-Fi network **10B** operates based on the mesh nodes **18** being fully interconnected with one another, sharing a channel such as a channel X between each of the mesh nodes **18** and the Wi-Fi client device **16**. That is, the Wi-Fi network **10B** is a fully interconnected grid, sharing the same channel, and allowing multiple different paths between the mesh nodes **18** and the Wi-Fi client device **16**. However, since the Wi-Fi network **10B** uses the same backhaul channel, every hop between source points divides the network capacity by the number of hops taken to deliver the data. For example, if it takes three hops to stream a video to a Wi-Fi client device **16**, the Wi-Fi network **10B** is left with only $\frac{1}{3}$ the capacity.

(21) The Wi-Fi network **10C** includes the access point **14** coupled wirelessly to a Wi-Fi repeater **20**. The Wi-Fi network **10C** with the repeaters **20** is a star topology where there is at most one Wi-Fi repeater **20** between the access point **14** and the Wi-Fi client device **16**. From a channel perspective, the access point **14** can communicate to the Wi-Fi repeater **20** on a first channel, Ch. X, and the Wi-Fi repeater **20** can communicate to the Wi-Fi client device **16** on a second channel, Ch. Y. The Wi-Fi network **10C** solves the problem with the Wi-Fi mesh network of requiring the same channel for all connections by using a different channel or band for the various hops (note, some hops may use the same channel/band, but it is not required), to prevent slowing down the Wi-Fi speed. One disadvantage of the repeater **20** is that it may have a different service set identifier (SSID), from the access point **14**, i.e., effectively different Wi-Fi networks from the perspective of the Wi-Fi client devices **16**.

(22) Despite Wi-Fi's popularity and ubiquity, many consumers still experience difficulties with Wi-Fi. The challenges of supplying real-time media applications, like those listed above, put increasing demands on the throughput, latency, jitter, and robustness of Wi-Fi. Studies have shown that

broadband access to the Internet through service providers is up 99.9% of the time at high data rates. However, despite the Internet arriving reliably and fast to the edge of consumer's homes, simply distributing the connection across the home via Wi-Fi is much less reliable leading to poor user experience.

(23) Several issues prevent conventional Wi-Fi systems from performing well, including i) interference, ii) congestion, and iii) coverage. For interference, with the growth of Wi-Fi has come the growth of interference between different Wi-Fi networks which overlap. When two networks within range of each other carry high levels of traffic, they interfere with each other, reducing the throughput that either network can achieve. For congestion, within a single Wi-Fi network, there may be several communications sessions running. When several demanding applications are running, such as high-definition video streams, the network can become saturated, leaving insufficient capacity to support the video streams.

(24) For coverage, Wi-Fi signals attenuate with distance and when traveling through walls and other objects. In many environments, such as residences, reliable Wi-Fi service cannot be obtained in all rooms. Even if a basic connection can be obtained in all rooms, many of those locations will have poor performance due to a weak Wi-Fi signal. Various objects in a residence such as walls, doors, mirrors, people, and general clutter all interfere and attenuate Wi-Fi signals leading to slower data rates.

(25) Two general approaches have been tried to improve the performance of conventional Wi-Fi systems, as illustrated in the Wi-Fi networks **1A**, **10B**, **10C**. The first approach (the Wi-Fi network **10A**) is to simply build more powerful single access points, in an attempt to cover a location with stronger signal strengths, thereby providing more complete coverage and higher data rates at a given location. However, this approach is limited by both regulatory limits on the allowed transmit power, and by the fundamental laws of nature. The difficulty of making such a powerful access point, whether by increasing the power, or increasing the number of transmit and receive antennas, grows exponentially with the achieved improvement. Practical improvements using these techniques lie in the range of 6 to 12 dB. However, a single additional wall can attenuate by 12 dB. Therefore, despite the huge difficulty and expense to gain 12 dB of the link budget, the resulting system may not be able to transmit through even one additional wall. Any coverage holes that may have existed will still be present, devices that suffer poor throughput will still achieve relatively poor throughput, and the overall system capacity will be only modestly improved. In addition, this approach does nothing to improve the situation with interference and congestion. In fact, by increasing the transmit power, the amount of interference between networks actually goes up.

(26) A second approach is to use repeaters or a mesh of Wi-Fi devices to repeat the Wi-Fi data throughout a location, as illustrated in the Wi-Fi networks **10B**, **10C**. This approach is a fundamentally better approach to achieving better coverage. By placing even a single repeater **20** in the center of a house, the distance that a single Wi-Fi transmission must traverse can be cut in half, halving also the number of walls that each hop of the Wi-Fi signal must traverse. This can make a change in the link budget of 40 dB or more, a huge change compared to the 6 to 12 dB type improvements that can be obtained by enhancing a single access point as described above. Mesh networks have similar properties as systems using Wi-Fi repeaters **20**. A fully interconnected mesh adds the ability for all the mesh nodes **18** to be able to communicate with each other, opening the possibility of packets being delivered via multiple hops following an arbitrary pathway through the network.

(27) The Wi-Fi network **10D** includes various Wi-Fi devices **22** that can be interconnected to one another wirelessly (Wi-Fi wireless backhaul links) or wired, in a tree topology where there is one path between the Wi-Fi client device **16** and the gateway (the Wi-Fi device **22** connected to the Internet), but which allows for multiple wireless hops unlike the Wi-Fi repeater network and multiple channels unlike the Wi-Fi mesh network. For example, the Wi-Fi network **10D** can use different channels/bands between Wi-Fi devices **22** and between the Wi-Fi client device **16** (e.g.,

Ch. X, Y, Z, A), and, also, the Wi-Fi system **10** does not necessarily use every Wi-Fi device **22**, based on configuration and optimization. The Wi-Fi network **10D** is not constrained to a star topology as in the Wi-Fi repeater network which at most allows two wireless hops between the Wi-Fi client device **16** and a gateway. Wi-Fi is a shared, simplex protocol meaning only one conversation between two devices can occur in the network at any given time, and if one device is talking the others need to be listening. By using different Wi-Fi channels, multiple simultaneous conversations can happen simultaneously in the Wi-Fi network **10D**. By selecting different Wi-Fi channels between the Wi-Fi devices **22**, interference and congestion can be avoided or minimized. (28) Of note, the systems and methods described herein contemplate operation through any of the Wi-Fi networks **10**, including other topologies not explicated described herein. Also, if there are certain aspects of the systems and methods which require multiple nodes in the Wi-Fi network **10**, this would exclude the Wi-Fi network **10A**.

§ 1.1 Cloud-Based Control

(29) FIG. 2A is a network diagram of the Wi-Fi network **10** with cloud-based control. The Wi-Fi network **10** includes a gateway device which is any of the access points **14**, the mesh node **18**, or the Wi-Fi device **22** that connects to a modem/router **30** that is connected to the Internet **12**. For external network connectivity, the modem/router **30** which can be a cable modem, Digital Subscriber Loop (DSL) modem, cellular interface, or any device providing external network connectivity to the physical location associated with the Wi-Fi network **10**. In an embodiment, the Wi-Fi network **10** can include centralized control such as via a cloud service **40** located on the Internet **12** and configured to control multiple Wi-Fi networks **10**. The cloud service **40** can receive measurement data, analyze the measurement data, and configure the nodes in the Wi-Fi network **10** based thereon. This cloud-based control is contrasted with a conventional operation that relies on a local configuration such as by logging in locally to an access point.

(30) Of note, cloud-based control can be implemented with any of the Wi-Fi networks **10**, with monitoring through the cloud service **40**. For example, different vendors can make access points **14**, mesh nodes **18**, repeaters **20**, Wi-Fi devices **22**, etc. However, it is possible for unified control via the cloud using standardized techniques for communication with the cloud service **40**. One such example includes OpenSync, sponsored by the Applicant of the present disclosure and described at www.opensync.io/documentation. OpenSync is cloud-agnostic open-source software for the delivery, curation, and management of services for the modern home. That is, this provides standardization of the communication between devices and the cloud service **40**. OpenSync acts as silicon, Customer Premises Equipment (CPE), and cloud-agnostic connection between the in-home hardware devices and the cloud service **40**. This is used to collect measurements and statistics from the connected Wi-Fi client devices **16** and network management elements, and to enable customized connectivity services.

(31) As described herein, cloud-based management includes reporting of Wi-Fi related performance metrics to the cloud service **40** as well as receiving Wi-Fi-related configuration parameters from the cloud service **40**. The systems and methods contemplate use with any Wi-Fi network **10**. The cloud service **40** utilizes cloud computing systems and methods to abstract away physical servers, storage, networking, etc. and instead offer these as on-demand and elastic resources. The National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) provides a concise and specific definition which states cloud computing is a model for enabling convenient, on-demand network access to a shared pool of configurable computing resources (e.g., networks, servers, storage, applications, and services) that can be rapidly provisioned and released with minimal management effort or service provider interaction. Cloud computing differs from the classic client-server model by providing applications from a server that are executed and managed by a client's web browser or the like, with no installed client version of an application required. Centralization gives cloud service providers complete control over the versions of the browser-based and other applications provided to clients, which removes the need for version upgrades or license management on individual client

computing devices. The phrase SaaS is sometimes used to describe application programs offered through cloud computing. A common shorthand for a provided cloud computing service (or even an aggregation of all existing cloud services) is “the cloud.”

§ 1.2 Distributed Wi-Fi Network

(32) FIG. 2B is a network diagram of an example implementation the Wi-Fi network **10D**, as a distributed Wi-Fi network in a tree topology. The distributed Wi-Fi network **10D** includes a plurality of access points **22** (labeled as access points **22A-22H**) which can be distributed throughout a location, such as a residence, office, or the like. That is, the distributed Wi-Fi **10D** contemplates operation in any physical location where it is inefficient or impractical to service with a single access point, repeaters, or a mesh system. In a typical deployment, the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D** can include between 1 to 12 access points or more in a home. A large number of access points **22** (which can also be referred to as nodes in the distributed Wi-Fi system **10**) ensures that the distance between any access point **22** is always small, as is the distance to any Wi-Fi client device **16** needing Wi-Fi service. That is, an objective of the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D** is for distances between the access points **22** to be of similar size as distances between the Wi-Fi client devices **16** and the associated access point **22**. Such small distances ensure that every corner of a consumer's home is well covered by Wi-Fi signals. It also ensures that any given hop in the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D** is short and goes through few walls. This results in very strong signal strengths for each hop in the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D**, allowing the use of high data rates, and providing robust operation.

(33) For external network connectivity, one or more of the access points **14** can be connected to a modem/router **30** which can be a cable modem, Digital Subscriber Loop (DSL) modem, or any device providing external network connectivity to the physical location associated with the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D**.

(34) While providing excellent coverage, a large number of access points **22** (nodes) presents a coordination problem. Getting all the access points **22** configured correctly and communicating efficiently requires centralized control. This control is preferably done via the cloud service **40** that can be reached across the Internet **12** and accessed remotely such as through an application (“app”) running on a client device **16**. That is, in an exemplary aspect, the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D** includes cloud-based control (with a cloud-based controller or cloud service) to optimize, configure, and monitor the operation of the access points **22** and the Wi-Fi client devices **16**. This cloud-based control is contrasted with a conventional operation which relies on a local configuration such as by logging in locally to an access point. In the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D**, the control and optimization does not require local login to the access point **22**, but rather the Wi-Fi client device **16** communicating with the cloud service **4**, such as via a disparate network (a different network than the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D**) (e.g., LTE, another Wi-Fi network, etc.).

(35) The access points **22** can include both wireless links and wired links for connectivity. In the example of FIG. 2B, the access point **22A** has an exemplary gigabit Ethernet (GbE) wired connection to the modem/router **40**. Optionally, the access point **22B** also has a wired connection to the modem/router **40**, such as for redundancy or load balancing. Also, the access points **22A**, **22B** can have a wireless connection to the modem/router **40**. Additionally, the access points **22A**, **22B** can have a wireless gateway such as to a cellular provider as is described in detail herein. The access points **22** can have wireless links for client connectivity (referred to as a client link) and for backhaul (referred to as a backhaul link). The distributed Wi-Fi network **10F** differs from a conventional Wi-Fi mesh network in that the client links and the backhaul links do not necessarily share the same Wi-Fi channel, thereby reducing interference. That is, the access points **22** can support at least two Wi-Fi wireless channels—which can be used flexibly to serve either the client link or the backhaul link and may have at least one wired port for connectivity to the modem/router **40**, or for connection to other devices. In the distributed Wi-Fi network **10D**, only a small subset of the access points **22** require direct connectivity to the modem/router **40** with the non-connected

access points **22** communicating with the modem/router **40** through the backhaul links back to the connected access points **22A**, **22B**. Of course, the backhaul links may also be wired Ethernet connections, such as in a location have a wired infrastructure.

§ 2.0 Access Point

(36) FIG. **3** is a block diagram of functional components of the access points **14**, mesh nodes **18**, repeaters **20**, etc. (“node”) in the Wi-Fi networks **10**. The node includes a physical form factor **100** which contains a processor **102**, a plurality of radios **104A**, **104B**, a local interface **106**, a data store **108**, a network interface **110**, and power **112**. It should be appreciated by those of ordinary skill in the art that FIG. **3** depicts the node in an oversimplified manner, and a practical embodiment may include additional components and suitably configured processing logic to support features described herein or known or conventional operating features that are not described in detail herein.

(37) In an embodiment, the form factor **100** is a compact physical implementation where the node directly plugs into an electrical socket and is physically supported by the electrical plug connected to the electrical socket. This compact physical implementation is ideal for a large number of nodes distributed throughout a residence. The processor **102** is a hardware device for executing software instructions. The processor **102** can be any custom made or commercially available processor, a central processing unit (CPU), an auxiliary processor among several processors, a semiconductor-based microprocessor (in the form of a microchip or chipset), or generally any device for executing software instructions. When the node is in operation, the processor **102** is configured to execute software stored within memory or the data store **108**, to communicate data to and from the memory or the data store **108**, and to generally control operations of the access point **14** pursuant to the software instructions. In an embodiment, the processor **102** may include a mobile optimized processor such as optimized for power consumption and mobile applications.

(38) The radios **104A** enable wireless communication in the Wi-Fi network **10**. The radios **104S** can operate according to the IEEE 802.11 standard. The radios **104B** support cellular connectivity such as Long Term Evolution (LTE), 5G, and the like. The radios **104A**, **104B** include address, control, and/or data connections to enable appropriate communications on the Wi-Fi network **10** and a cellular network, respectively. As described herein, the node can include a plurality of radios **104A** to support different links, i.e., backhaul links and client links. The radios **104A** can also include Wi-Fi chipsets configured to perform IEEE 802.11 operations. In an embodiment, an optimization can determine the configuration of the radios **104S** such as bandwidth, channels, topology, etc. In an embodiment, the node supports dual-band operation simultaneously operating 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz 2×2 MIMO 802.11b/g/n/ac radios having operating bandwidths of 20/40 MHz for 2.4 GHz and 20/40/80 MHz for 5 GHz. For example, the node can support IEEE 802.11AC1200 gigabit Wi-Fi (300+867 Mbps). Also, the node can support additional frequency bands such as 6 GHz, as well as cellular connections. The radios **104B** can include cellular chipsets and the like to support fixed wireless access.

(39) Also, the radios **104A**, **104B** include antennas designed to fit in the form factor **100**. An example is described in commonly-assigned U.S. patent Ser. No. 17/857,377, entitled “Highly isolated and barely separated antennas integrated with noise free RF-transparent Printed Circuit Board (PCB) for enhanced radiated sensitivity,” filed Jul. 5, 2022, the contents of which are incorporated by reference in their entirety.

(40) The local interface **106** is configured for local communication to the node and can be either a wired connection or wireless connection such as Bluetooth or the like. Since the node can be configured via the cloud service **40**, an onboarding process is required to first establish connectivity for a newly turned on node. In an embodiment, the node can also include the local interface **106** allowing connectivity to a Wi-Fi client device **16** for onboarding to the Wi-Fi network **10** such as through an app on the user device **22**. The data store **108** is used to store data. The data store **108** may include any of volatile memory elements (e.g., random access memory (RAM, such as DRAM, SRAM, SDRAM, and the like)), nonvolatile memory elements (e.g., ROM, hard drive,

tape, CDROM, and the like), and combinations thereof. Moreover, the data store **108** may incorporate electronic, magnetic, optical, and/or other types of storage media.

(41) The network interface **110** provides wired connectivity to the node. The network interface **110** may be used to enable the node communicates to the modem/router **40**. Also, the network interface **110** can be used to provide local connectivity to a Wi-Fi client device **16** or another access point **22**. For example, wiring in a device to a node can provide network access to a device that does not support Wi-Fi. In an embodiment, all of the nodes in the Wi-Fi network **10D** include the network interface **110**. In another embodiment, select nodes, which connect to the modem/router **30** or require local wired connections have the network interface **110**. The network interface **110** may include, for example, an Ethernet card or adapter (e.g., 10BaseT, Fast Ethernet, Gigabit Ethernet, 10 GbE). The network interface **110** may include address, control, and/or data connections to enable appropriate communications on the network.

(42) The processor **102** and the data store **108** can include software and/or firmware which essentially controls the operation of the node, data gathering and measurement control, data management, memory management, and communication and control interfaces with the cloud service **40**. The processor **102** and the data store **108** may be configured to implement the various processes, algorithms, methods, techniques, etc. described herein.

(43) Also, those skilled in the art will appreciate there can be various physical implementations which are contemplated herein. For example, in some embodiments, the modem/router **30** can be integrated with the access point **14**, **18**, **22**. In other embodiments, just a router can be integrated with the access point **14**, **18**, **22** with separate connectivity to a modem.

§ 3.0 Cloud Server and User Device

(44) FIG. **4** is a block diagram of functional components of a server **200**, a Wi-Fi client device **16**, or a user device that may be used with the Wi-Fi network of FIG. **1** or **2B**, and/or the cloud-based control of FIG. **2A**. The server **200** may be a digital computer that, in terms of hardware architecture, generally includes a processor **202**, input/output (I/O) interfaces **204**, a network interface **206**, a data store **208**, and memory **210**. It should be appreciated by those of ordinary skill in the art that FIG. **4** depicts the server **200** in an oversimplified manner, and a practical embodiment may include additional components and suitably configured processing logic to support features described herein or known or conventional operating features that are not described in detail herein.

(45) The components (**202**, **204**, **206**, **208**, and **210**) are communicatively coupled via a local interface **212**. The local interface **212** may be, for example, but not limited to, one or more buses or other wired or wireless connections, as is known in the art. The local interface **212** may have additional elements, which are omitted for simplicity, such as controllers, buffers (caches), drivers, repeaters, and receivers, among many others, to enable communications. Further, the local interface **212** may include address, control, and/or data connections to enable appropriate communications among the aforementioned components.

(46) The processor **202** is a hardware device for executing software instructions. The processor **202** may be any custom made or commercially available processor, a central processing unit (CPU), an auxiliary processor among several processors associated with the server **200**, a semiconductor-based microprocessor (in the form of a microchip or chipset), or generally any device for executing software instructions. When the server **200** is in operation, the processor **202** is configured to execute software stored within the memory **210**, to communicate data to and from the memory **210**, and to generally control operations of the server **200** pursuant to the software instructions. The I/O interfaces **204** may be used to receive user input from and/or for providing system output to one or more devices or components. The user input may be provided via, for example, a keyboard, touchpad, and/or a mouse. System output may be provided via a display device and a printer (not shown). I/O interfaces **204** may include, for example, a serial port, a parallel port, a small computer system interface (SCSI), a serial ATA (SATA), a fibre channel, Infiniband, iSCSI, a PCI Express

interface (PCI-x), an infrared (IR) interface, a radio frequency (RF) interface, and/or a universal serial bus (USB) interface.

(47) The network interface **206** may be used to enable the server **200** to communicate on a network, such as the cloud service **40**. The network interface **206** may include, for example, an Ethernet card or adapter (e.g., 10BaseT, Fast Ethernet, Gigabit Ethernet, 10 GbE) or a wireless local area network (WLAN) card or adapter (e.g., 802.11a/b/g/n/ac). The network interface **206** may include address, control, and/or data connections to enable appropriate communications on the network. A data store **208** may be used to store data. The data store **208** may include any of volatile memory elements (e.g., random access memory (RAM, such as DRAM, SRAM, SDRAM, and the like)), nonvolatile memory elements (e.g., ROM, hard drive, tape, CDROM, and the like), and combinations thereof. Moreover, the data store **208** may incorporate electronic, magnetic, optical, and/or other types of storage media. In one example, the data store **208** may be located internal to the server **200** such as, for example, an internal hard drive connected to the local interface **212** in the server **200**.

Additionally, in another embodiment, the data store **208** may be located external to the server **200** such as, for example, an external hard drive connected to the I/O interfaces **204** (e.g., SCSI or USB connection). In a further embodiment, the data store **208** may be connected to the server **200** through a network, such as, for example, a network-attached file server.

(48) The memory **210** may include any of volatile memory elements (e.g., random access memory (RAM, such as DRAM, SRAM, SDRAM, etc.)), nonvolatile memory elements (e.g., ROM, hard drive, tape, CDROM, etc.), and combinations thereof. Moreover, the memory **210** may incorporate electronic, magnetic, optical, and/or other types of storage media. Note that the memory **210** may have a distributed architecture, where various components are situated remotely from one another but can be accessed by the processor **202**. The software in memory **210** may include one or more software programs, each of which includes an ordered listing of executable instructions for implementing logical functions. The software in the memory **210** includes a suitable operating system (O/S) **214** and one or more programs **216**. The operating system **214** essentially controls the execution of other computer programs, such as the one or more programs **216**, and provides scheduling, input-output control, file and data management, memory management, and communication control and related services. The one or more programs **216** may be configured to implement the various processes, algorithms, methods, techniques, etc. described herein, such as related to the optimization.

§ 4.0 Wi-Fi Network with Wired and Wireless Connectivity

(49) Again, the wireless access points **14**, **18**, **22** include both the Wi-Fi radios **104A**, the cellular radios **104B**, and the network interface **110**. The network interface **110** can include an Ethernet connection to the modem/router **30**. In an embodiment, the cellular radios **104B** can provide a backup connection to the Ethernet connection, for connectivity to the Internet. Of note, the access point **14**, **18**, **22** with the cellular radios **104B** can be referred to as a gateway **30A** node. That is, the term gateway **30A** is meant to cover any access point **14**, **18**, **22**, modem/router, etc. or combination thereof that enables connectivity to the Internet **12** for the Wi-Fi network **10**. Note, in some embodiments, a modem is separate from the access point **14**, **18**, **22**. In other embodiments, the access point **14**, **18**, **22**, include a router. In still other embodiments, the access point **14**, **18**, **22** can include a modem/router. Those skilled in the art will recognize various approaches are contemplated and all such equivalents are considered herewith.

(50) FIG. 5 is a network diagram of a portion of a network **300** associated with a network operator. In this example, the network operator includes both wired and wireless broadband in the same geographical area, represented by homes **302**. For example, the wired broadband can be via modems/routers **30** that can connect ultimately to a cable modem termination system (CMTS) **304** (or some other type of wired infrastructure, e.g., DSL, Passive Optical Network (PON), Hybrid Fiber Coax (HFC), etc.), and the wireless broadband can be via fixed wireless access via the cellular radios **104B** in the access points **14**, **18**, **22** that connect to a base station **306** (e.g.,

eNodeB, gNodeB, etc.). It would be advantageous to support failover to the wireless broadband in the case of a wired broadband failure, providing reliability, uptime, and high service level agreement (SLA) support. In the case of a single outage, this is not an issue on the wireless network. However, often wired failures are geographically localized. For example, failure of the CMTS **304** causes a burden on the base station **306** because the wired broadband failure is geographically localized to the homes **302**. This could dramatically put a burden on the base station **306** or other cellular cells in the area, leading to degradation of services for all mobile users in the area. That is, wired broadband outages tend to be localized and using wireless broadband for failover could inundate the cellular network.

§ 4.1 Fixed Wireless Access System

(51) FIG. **6** is a diagram of a fixed wireless access system **400** for wired and/or wireless connectivity. For illustration purposes, the fixed wireless access system **400** is illustrated with a single home **302** having a modem/router **30** and a Wi-Fi client device **16**. Those skilled in the art will recognize the fixed wireless access system **400** contemplates multiple locations, including homes, businesses, store, library, mall, sporting area, or any location where a Wi-Fi network **10** is deployed. Further, the fixed wireless access system **400** contemplates use with various different Wi-Fi networks **10**, with various different network operators, etc. Also, the fixed wireless access system **400** contemplates use with any of the various wired and/or wireless connectivity schemes described herein.

(52) The cloud service **40** is configured to connect to the Wi-Fi network **10**, either via a wired connection **402** and/or a wireless connection **404**. In an embodiment, the cloud service **40** can be utilized for configuration, monitoring, and reporting of the Wi-Fi networks **10** in the homes **302** or other locations. The cloud service **40** can be configured to detect outages such as for the wired connections **402**. For example, this functionality is described in commonly-assigned U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/700,782, filed Mar. 22, 2022, and entitled “Intelligent monitoring systems and methods for Wi-Fi Metric-Based ISP Outage Detection for Cloud Based Wi-Fi Networks,” the contents of which are incorporated by reference in their entirety.

(53) Also, the cloud service **40** can connect to a 5G cloud control plane **410** and can determine 5G to Wi-Fi quality of experience (QoE) monitoring and application prioritization controls for increased service consistency. QoE analytics can be shared with 5G cloud control plane **410** for network optimization feedback.

(54) In an embodiment, the access points **14**, **18**, **20**, **22** and/or gateway **30A** can include OpenSync support for communicating with the cloud service **40**.

§ 4.2 Wi-Fi Network Failover to Cellular Connection with Throttling of Traffic

(55) In the case where a configuration and reporting is implemented between the home **302** (i.e., gateways **30A**) and a central controller or the cloud service **40**, the cloud can know, based on reports from the gateways **30A**: 1) Which homes have failed over from the wired broadband to the cellular network. 2) Which serving cells are within range of each home gateway—an input received from the mobile operator, or cellular service degradation detected by the home gateways **30A**.

(56) In an embodiment, the present disclosure includes failover to the cellular network when there is a failure of wired connections along with throttling of traffic, via the cloud service **40**.

Specifically, it is undesirable to overload the cellular network; this is particularly true if there is a widescale or regional outage that causes a large number of homes **302** to fail over to cellular in the same region. Also, some cellular plans include pay per data schemes and it would be undesirable for users to get high bills. Further, cellular is typically a lower data rate than the wired connection **402** and it makes sense to throttle to highest priority traffic to preserve real time performance.

(57) FIG. **7** is a flowchart of a process **450** for Wi-Fi network **10** failover to cellular connection with throttling of traffic. The process **450** contemplates implementation as a method having steps, via a processing device configured to execute the steps, as instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium, and via the cloud service **40**.

(58) The process **450** includes detecting an outage on wired connections for any of the plurality of Wi-Fi networks (step **452**); determining the any of the plurality of Wi-Fi networks have switched to a cellular connection as a failover based on the outage (step **454**); and determining whether to throttle traffic on any cellular connection based on the failover and instructing corresponding gateways **30A** accordingly (step **456**).

(59) Again, the cloud service **40** can be connected to multiple Wi-Fi networks **10**. The outage can be detected based on the plurality of Wi-Fi networks **10** communicating the wired connections are down. Also, the users can be correlated geographically.

(60) The traffic can be throttled by instructing the gateway **30A** accordingly. For example, the access points **14**, **18**, **20**, **22** can be configured to perform the throttling. In an embodiment, the traffic is throttled based on any of specific applications and specific uses. For the application, this includes the Wi-Fi networks **10** identifying the application, such as by packet inspection. The application-based throttling can identify high-priority applications for service (e.g., security monitoring, voice/video conferencing, etc.) as well as penalizing low-priority applications (e.g., data synchronization, entertainment, etc.). Also, the throttling can block specific uses such as system updates, backups, etc. For example, the specific uses can be ones that are not necessarily time critical and can wait for the restoration of the wired connection.

(61) In an embodiment, the traffic can be throttled via a hard cap on how much data can flow through the cellular connection. In another embodiment, the traffic can be throttled by throughput, e.g., Mb/sec. In a further embodiment, the traffic can be throttled based on total data moved. For example, let all applications run until some total amount of data has been transferred and start to throttle after some limit has been reached. The limit could be per period of time, such as an hour, day, week, month, etc.

(62) The traffic can be throttled based on virtual or conceptual local networks that are operational in the plurality of Wi-Fi networks and that have different priorities. This can include discriminating the throttling by different virtual or conceptual, or even actual physical local networks (LANs) based on assigned priorities. For example, throttle only on low-priority networks, such as a guest network or the like. Also, it is possible to prioritize certain networks such as an infrastructure network that is used for high-priority applications.

(63) The throttling can be only under certain circumstances. For example, throttle only when there is a wide area outage, such as more than a certain number of users failover onto cellular. Another approach can include throttling only when the cellular network (infrastructure) indicates to the cloud service **40** that it is overloaded. A further approach can include a cellular device (e.g., the gateway **30A** with a cellular connection) indicating that the cell appears to be getting overloaded. A further approach can include throttling applied differently to different users/subscribers depending on the tier of their subscription,

(64) Determining whether to throttle traffic can be based on feedback from a cellular control plane to the cloud service. The process **450** can further include steering the corresponding gateways **30A** to different base stations to limit a load on any given base station. The process **450** can further include receiving information from the corresponding gateways **30A** related to the cellular connection including an identification of a corresponding base station. The process **450** can further include receiving information from the corresponding gateways **30A** related to the cellular connection including an identification of visible base stations; and steering the corresponding gateways **30A** to different base stations.

(65) In an embodiment, the cloud service **40** can be configured to limit the load on a particular base station, such as by distributing devices. This can be via the fixed wireless access system **400**. The cloud service **40** can steer different cellular devices (UEs) to different base stations to limit the load put upon any given base station.

(66) In an embodiment, the cloud service **40** can assign the base station to failover via cell ID beforehand, and this set of assignments could be distributed across all cells/base stations in a given

area. In another embodiment, gateways **30A** can make their own choice of base station and report to the cloud service **40** where they have connected. The cloud service **40** can then analyze the loads and cause the gateways **30A** to move to different base stations as needed to adjust the load. In a further embodiment, there can be a blacklist (preventing connection) and a whitelist (allowing connection) for cells/base stations. This still allows the gateways **30A** some flexibility in choosing the cell that works best for it.

(67) In another embodiment, it is possible to have the gateways **30A** connect on 4G vs. 5G—as base stations if independent capacity on 4G and 5G for distributing the load across all the resources. This selection should be made intelligently—gateways **30A** that need higher throughput should connect on 5G, gateways with lower throughput connect on 4G. That is, the gateways **30A** can connect on different bands by having the gateways **30A** advertise different band capabilities. All of the above can be programmed before the outage happens, or it could be programmed after the outage starts, as a way to correct an overload on a particular base station. The cloud service **40** can determine overload at a base station without any information from the base station if each gateway **30A** reports to the cloud service **40** the amount of data it is moving and which base station, band, and/or technology that it is using.

(68) This process can be aided if the devices (gateways **30A**, etc.) report all the base stations they are able to see and could potentially connect to. If the cloud service **40** has collaboration with a cellular carrier, they could provide the cloud service **40** data about the cell loads and utilization, which would help in determining where the gateways **30A** should fail over to.

§ 5.0 Installation of Wi-Fi Access Points with Cellular Connection

(69) A gateway **30A** that includes the cellular radios **104B** (“cellular gateway”) will be located indoors, typically. It is important to place the cellular gateway **30A** at a good reception area of strong signal strength and quality for better cellular experience (high speed, etc.). The present disclosure includes various approaches for optimizing the location of the cellular gateway **30A**. In an embodiment, the present disclosure includes use of a mobile device for estimating signal strength/quality, instead of moving the cellular gateway **30A**. In another embodiment, the cellular gateway **30A** can be provided with a power bank (e.g., USB-based) to temporarily power the cellular gateway **30A** while it is moved around. In a further embodiment, general heuristics can be provided for best practice as to where to locate. Also, in the case where the cellular connection is used as a backup for failover, the cellular gateway **30A** does not necessarily have to be the same as the modem/router **30**, i.e., the wireless and wired connections can be at different locations.

§ 5.1 Mobile Device as a Sensor

(70) In an embodiment, instead of moving the cellular gateway **30A** around the home **302** by plugging and unplugging, the idea is to estimate the cellular gateway's **30A** signal strength on a customer's mobile device **16A** while walking indoor but without moving the cellular gateway **30A**. FIG. 8 is a diagram of a house **302** with multiple locations #1-#4 to place the cellular gateway **30A**. The requirements to use the mobile device **16A** as a sensor include knowing the cellular frequency band and Reference Signal Received Power (RSRP) of the cellular gateway **30A**, and the cellular frequency band and Signal Strength (RSRP) of the mobile device **16A** which includes a mobile application for operation with the cloud service **40** or a browser session with the cloud service **40**. (71) The objective or output of the sensor is the estimated signal strength (RSRP) of the cellular gateway **30A** on the mobile application or browser session while moving around in the home **302** to find the best spot for the cellular gateway's **30A** cellular reception. For example, signal strength can be transformed into signal bars or narrative such as excellent, very good, etc. for easy interpretation by a user.

(72) Rural and urban morphology varies the difference in path loss between different frequency bands. If a serving cellular band of the cellular gateway **30A** and the mobile device **16A** are the same, then the mobile device **16A** can be used to find the best spot within the home **302** for the cellular gateway **30A** while walking around using signal strength or bars or some other indication.

However, there are limitations, outlined in as follows. If serving cellular band of the cellular gateway **30A** and the mobile device **16A** are different, then by using the delta in path loss between different cellular bands (could be fixed or learned over time), the cellular gateway's **30A** signal strength can be estimated using the mobile device's **16A** location at various parts of home. If cellular gateway's **30A** cellular provider is different from the mobile device **16A** cellular service provider, then the estimate can be slightly off because network assets (cellular tower) might be located differently for different cellular carriers around the customer's home **302**.

§ 5.2 Delta of Signal Strengths Between Different Bands Using FSL

(73) FSL (free space loss equation) provides a rough estimation as shown below:

(74) TABLE-US-00001 Cellular gateway User's mobile device Delta dB (using FSL)

	1 700 MHz	2100 MHz	9.54	2 700 MHz	800 MHz	1.16	3 700 MHz	1900 MHz	8.67	4 700 MHz	2300 MHz	10.33	5 700 MHz	2500 MHz	11.06	6 700 MHz	3700 MHz	14.46	7 700 MHz	3500 MHz	13.98	8 700 MHz	5000 MHz	17.08
--	-----------	----------	------	-----------	---------	------	-----------	----------	------	-----------	----------	-------	-----------	----------	-------	-----------	----------	-------	-----------	----------	-------	-----------	----------	-------

(75) Using the above table, first row shows the case where the cellular gateway **30A** is camped on 700 MHz (Band 12, 13 or 14) while the mobile device **16A** is on 2100 Mhz (Band 4 or 66). Due to propagation differences, the cellular gateway's **30A** signal strength can be estimated on the mobile device **16A** by adding 9.54 dB to the mobile device's **16A** signal strength. While walking around the home, the mobile device's **16A** signal strength will vary resulting in varying signal strength for pod as well by ~9.54 dB. The same approach can be used with the other rows.

§ 5.3 Example Operations

(76) If the cellular network carrier for the cellular gateway **30A** and the mobile device **16A** are same, then there can be two cases based on serving frequency bands of the cellular gateway **30A** and the mobile device **16A**. With reference to FIG. **8** as an example, assume both the cellular gateway **30A** and the mobile device **16A** are using the same cellular carrier and connected to the same frequency band. Assume for this case, both the mobile device **16A** and the cellular gateway **30A** are connected to band 66 AWS/2100 MHz. At location #1, the cellular gateway **30A** measures -100 dBm and the mobile device **16A** measures -104 dBm. A user walks the mobile device **16A** to the location #2 and measures -110 dBm. Next, the user walks the mobile device **16A** to the location #3 and measures -100 dBm. Finally, the user walks the mobile device **16A** to the location #4 and measures -99 dBm, and a recommendation is provided to move the cellular gateway **30A** to the location #4.

(77) For a second case, both the cellular gateway **30A** and the mobile device **16A** are using the same cellular carrier but connected to different frequency bands. Assume for this case, the cellular gateway **30A** is connected to band 66 AWS/2100 MHz while the mobile device **16A** is connected to band 12/700 MHz. At location #1, the cellular gateway **30A** measures -100 dBm and the mobile device **16A** measures -95 dBm. A user walks the mobile device **16A** to the location #2 and measures -100 dBm and the cellular gateway **30A** is estimated at -105 dBm. Next, the user walks the mobile device **16A** to the location #3 and measures -90 dBm and the cellular gateway **30A** is estimated at -95 dBm. Finally, the user walks the mobile device **16A** to the location #4 and measures -89 dBm and the cellular gateway **30A** is estimated at -94 dBm, and a recommendation is provided to move the cellular gateway **30A** to the location #4.

(78) However, as mentioned in the limitations above; if the cellular carriers are different as well as their serving cellular towers for the cellular gateway **30A** and the mobile device **16A** location than it can result in an incorrect recommendation if the cell towers are not collocated. Cellular carriers often share network assets to control cost of cellular tower/site development. In case of tower sharing (co-location) for the nearby cellular asset serving pod and customer's cellphone, either case 1 or case 2 can provide correct recommendation but tower co-location requires tower location identification.

§ 5.4 Process for Installation of Wi-Fi Access Points with Cellular Connection

(79) FIG. **9** is a flowchart of a process **500** for installation of a cellular gateway **30A** for a Wi-Fi

network **10**. The process **500** includes obtaining a cellular gateway **30A** that is configured to provide cellular connectivity to the Internet for an associated Wi-Fi network (step **502**); measuring a plurality of locations in a building for the Wi-Fi network (step **504**); and receiving an indication based on the measuring, on a mobile device, for locating the cellular gateway in the building (step **506**). The measuring can use any metrics for cellular connectivity, i.e., not just signal strength, but also quality or some multi-factor metric

(80) The mobile device **16A** can execute one of a mobile application and a browser session and communicates with the cellular gateway **30A** via any of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi. The mobile application can be associated with the cloud service **40**. The mobile device **16A** can get information from the cellular gateway **30A**, namely a current indication when the cellular gateway **30A** is installed. The mobile device **16A** can use this in the subsequent measurements as well.

(81) The measuring can be performed by the mobile device **16A** configured as a sensor, such that a user physically moves the mobile device **16A** to the plurality of locations. That is, it is typically easiest to move the mobile device **16A** and it can be used as a sensor. In an embodiment, the cellular connectivity of the cellular gateway and the mobile device are with a same network provider. In an embodiment, the cellular connectivity of the cellular gateway and the mobile device are on different frequency bands with a correction factor used to adjust a measurement by the mobile device to reflect a value for the cellular gateway. In another embodiment, the connectivity can be on the same bands, eliminating the need for the correction factor.

(82) If the mobile device **16A** has different band capabilities, but is with the same service provider, then an estimate can be built by deriving a calibration factor by putting the mobile device **16A** next to the cellular gateway **30A**, and finding the difference in the signal strength as reported by the cellular gateway **30A** on the band it wants to operate on, with the signal strength measured on the mobile device **16A** in the band that it is operating on. The difference becomes the calibration or correction factor and is applied in a constant way as the mobile device **16A** moves about the house. This allows an estimate of the signal strength at any point in the home from the mobile device **16A** that more accurately represents what the cellular gateway **30A** will achieve when it connects on that band.

(83) In another embodiment, to correct the measurement when the band is different, the default free space path loss calculation can be used to calculate the difference in signal strength between the bands (see the table below). This calculation might also take into account the loss of typical obstructions such as an exterior wall and factor that into the correction factor as well. It also might be possible to determine the correction factor statistically, taking the result from many different cellular gateway **30A** or mobile device **16A** measurements and comparing the strength of different bands from those measurements.

(84) In an embodiment, the cellular connectivity of the cellular gateway and the mobile device are with a different network provider. Of course, this complicates use of the mobile device **16A** as a sensor, e.g., they could be connected to different base stations. If the service or network provider is different between the mobile device **16A** and the cellular gateway **30A**, the mobile device **16A** can sense the other service provider's signal strengths by being forced into roaming mode. The mobile application can force the mobile device **16A** to go into roaming through an application programming interface (API). There might be an official command in the API, or it might use some sort of emergency mode to get it to roam. Another approach could include use of the subscriber identity module (SIM) from the cellular gateway **30A** in the mobile device **16A** so that the mobile device **16A** can serve as the sensor when the service provider for the mobile device **16A** is different from the service provider for the cellular gateway **30A**. The mobile application can instruct the user to do so with detailed instructions.

(85) In another embodiment, the measuring can be done by an installation sensor device which can be a very low-cost handheld battery powered device that reports signal strength, quality, or some multi-factor metric to guide the location of the cellular gateway **30A**. This installation sensor

device might be returned after the user completes the installation process. Instead of the installation sensor device, the cellular gateway **30A** can be configured for powering by a universal serial bus (USB) interface or the like via a battery power bank. This powering can be for full operation or for a sensor mode only for measuring. The battery power bank can be provided with the cellular gateway **30A**, obtained separately by the user, or via some device such as a laptop. In the sensor mode, the cellular gateway **30A** could only enable enough circuitry to measure and report cellular statistics over Bluetooth or Wi-Fi to the mobile device **16A**. Another approach would be for the user to plug the device into their laptop via USB, the laptop then powering the cellular gateway **30A** device and potentially serving as the display for the measurements taken, the measurements traveling over the USB connection to the laptop. It is even possible that the same could be done via a USB connection (or a lighting connector) to the mobile device **16A**, which would be more convenient to carry about the location together with the cellular gateway **30A**. Finally, this connection could be done via wireless charging for a battery on the cellular gateway **30A**.

(86) The cellular gateway **30A** can further include the wired connectivity to the Internet and the plurality of locations include ones in the building supporting the wired connectivity. Also, the Wi-Fi network **10** can include a plurality of access points with the cellular gateway **30A** connected to one access point and a wired gateway connected to a different access point. Here, e.g., the access point with the cellular capability, when the cellular capability is for backup and a wired connection is being used as primary, does not have to be the access point in the home that is connected to the wired connection (broadband modem or gateway with wired connection). In other words, one access point or gateway is connected via wired broadband connection, but a different access point is connected by cellular and can be located anywhere, not constrained to where the broadband access wire is located. Then when the network fails over, it changes which device in the network is the access point out to the broadband.

(87) In an embodiment, the process **500** includes providing results of the measuring to a cloud service. The process **500** can further include utilizing the results by the cloud service for any of analytics, development of heuristics, and providing advice or guidance to users. The cloud service **40** can be configured to build a database based on various measurements. This database can also be used for the following: To be aware of what cells are generally strongest in a particular location/neighborhood; Which bands are generally strongest in a location/neighborhood; Which service provider (carrier) has the strongest/weakest coverage in a particular neighborhood; Which service provider has more spectrum, larger carrier aggregation, etc. reflecting that it would have the highest data rates in a particular area; To potentially use all the signal strength measurements to triangulate back to where the cell towers are actually located and then would be able to predict coverage into a new neighborhood that has not had any devices in it previously; To be used for purposes other than locating the cellular gateway **30A** for other customers—perhaps just a generalized metric of coverage.

(88) For example, the cloud service **40** can use data gathered to generate heuristic rules about locating the cellular gateway **30A**, and provide that advice to the user through an installation app. The advice might be general such as “place it near a window”, or place it near an exterior wall. The advice might be specific to the location: “Place it near a north facing window”, which would be derived from having learned from nearby homes that the best cell coverage is coming from the north, or could be derived as a result of the base station triangulation described above, or it could be based on a priori knowledge of where the base stations are located.

§ 6.0 Geographic Limitation of Wi-Fi Access Points with Cellular Connection

(89) The cellular connection with the cellular gateway **30A** can be tied to a particular network operator. Also, the cellular gateway **30A** can be moved, taken to different locations, etc. That is, the cellular gateway **30A** is portable. Network operators may want to lock operation of the cellular gateway **30A** to a particular location, i.e., geolocation. This also covers the case where the cellular gateway **30A** is resold to a third party, i.e., geolocation control would prevent operation.

(90) Accordingly, in an embodiment, the present disclosure includes various approaches to lock operation of the cellular gateway **30A**. That is, prevent operation of the cellular gateway **30A**, i.e., 4G or 5G gateway/broadband access device depending on its geographic location. The motivation for this includes the following: a) blocking a user from selling the device to someone else, and then using it and its SIM permissions to get onto the network, b) blocking a user from moving from one place to another and using the device in the new location without contacting or getting permission from the network operator, c) allowing the network operator to properly limit the density of cellular access users in a given geographic area to make sure the cellular system is not overloaded, and d) making sure that cellular access is used only in the locations where it is truly needed in the case that a service provider offers both wired and wireless access, and is intending for the wireless access to be used only at the homes/areas where wired access is not conveniently available.

(91) FIG. **10** is a flowchart of a process **520** for geographically limiting a cellular gateway **30A** (“device”). There are four general steps including detecting where the device is operating (step **522**), determining if the device is allowed to operate in that location (step **524**), allowing/blocking the device in that location (step **526**), and, optionally, changing permissions for the location of where the device is allowed to operate (step **528**). Each is described in detail as follows.

(92) For detecting where the device is operating (step **522**), various approaches are contemplated, including approaches implemented at the cellular gateway **30A**, information from a user device connected to the cellular gateway **30A**, information from the cellular network/infrastructure itself, and combinations thereof. The cellular gateway **30A** could include a global positioning satellite (GPS) antenna to determine the location. Further, the cellular gateway **30A** can report what base station it is connected to for its location, as well as triangulate with other base stations. A user device includes a GPS antenna and can be used to share its location when it is connected to the cellular gateway **30A** via Wi-Fi. Further, the network/infrastructure can include similar techniques as the cellular gateway **30A**, namely determining the cellular gateway **30A** is connected to a particular base station as well as triangulation. Those skilled in the art will recognize there are various known techniques of geolocation, all of which are contemplated herewith.

(93) Again, the user device **16** can include the application which is used for control of the Wi-Fi network **10** including the cellular gateway **30A**. In an embodiment, the user device **16** with the application can connect to the cellular gateway **30A** for onboarding, such as via Bluetooth or Wi-Fi. As part of this process, the user device **16** can share its GPS coordinates with the cloud service **40**, including via a separate network such as a cellular network in which the user device **16** operates. The assumption here is that the user device **16** must be physically close to the cellular gateway **30A** if connected via either Bluetooth or Wi-Fi. When the cellular gateway **30A** onboards, the cloud service **40** can provide a list of preferred cell identifiers (IDs). The 5G manager in the cellular gateway **30A** can be configured to only allow it to attach to that list of preferred cell IDs, which will restrict it from attaching elsewhere unless it goes through the onboarding process again.

(94) Of note, the detecting can be referred to as geolocating, etc., and the timing of the geolocating can be at onboarding, on demand, and/or periodically on an ongoing basis. As described herein, the cellular gateway **30A** is configured to communicate with the cloud service **40** and can share the location thereto. In an embodiment, the cellular gateway **30A** can be configured to not operate unless it has shared its location with the cloud service **40** and received approval. If there is cooperation between the cellular network and the cloud service **40**, after onboarding the network operator of the cellular network could store information about where the cellular gateway **30A** is permitted to attach, including a list of cells, and a geographic specification which could be cross checked if the cellular gateway **30A** tries to connect to a cell in a different area.

(95) For determining if the device is allowed to operate in that location (step **524**), this can include a check of geolocation and device identifier against a database, such as managed by the cloud service **40**. The device identifier can be anything that uniquely identifies the cellular gateway **30A**, such as media access control (MAC) address, serial number, and the like. As described previously

the preferred cell IDs could be loaded into the cloud service **40** at the time of purchase or configuration, and specification during the purchase of the intended operating location. These preferred cell IDs could come from the network operator, and be loaded into the cloud service **40**, and subsequently during onboarding loaded into the cellular gateway **30A**.

(96) For allowing/blocking the device in that location (step **526**), allowing can be a default option with the blocking being something caused. Alternatively, blocking can be the default option with the allowing being something caused. The action of either blocking or allowing could occur in various locations. First, the action could be in the cellular gateway **30A** itself, such as in embedded software/firmware that controls operation of the cellular radio. Second, the action could be implemented by the cloud service **40**, including controlling a setting in the cellular gateway **30A**. For example, each time a cellular radio from the cellular gateway **30A** makes a new connection to the network, there can be a routine that checks to make sure this device is legitimate from a geolocation perspective, and, if not, the cloud service **40** can instruct the cellular gateway **30A** to disconnect from the cellular network. Third, the action could be within the cellular network, when a cellular gateway **30A** connects or tries to connect, the cellular infrastructure checks if its geolocation or base station selection is acceptable for the action.

(97) Also, blocking could be of the connection itself, i.e., the wireless connection between the cellular gateway **30A** and a base station, or it could be of passing traffic, or some hybrid combination. For example, it could be possible to allow a cellular gateway **30A** to connect and operate, and then determine it is in the wrong location. When detected in the wrong location, the action can be any of: a) block data flow while leaving it on the network, b) allow data flow for a period of time while alerting the user through an application notification, email, text message, push notification, etc., of the problem, c) allow data flow for a period of time, but turn it off later, and disconnect the cellular gateway **30A** to prevent even the small “idle” load on the network, and/or d) allow the cellular gateway **30A** to remain connected to the network, but allow it only to communicate with the cloud service **40** such that management can be applied to it, including seeing things about the cellular gateway **30A** if the customer calls for support, or reconfiguring the device to allow connection in the new location.

(98) For, optionally, changing permissions for the location of where the device is allowed to operate (step **528**), there may be legitimate reasons to move where the cellular gateway **30A** is allowed to operate (the customer is moving, the cellular gateway **30A** is being recommissioned to a new customer in a new location, etc.). This can include changing the geolocation information stored in the database for that cellular gateway **30A**, i.e., in the cloud service **40**. It could also include changing the preferred base station list for the cellular gateway **30A**, i.e., in the cloud service **40**. The change can include forcing the cellular gateway **30A** to go through the onboarding process again—loading a new geo limitation or preferred cell list through the onboarding process. The change can also include forcing it through re-onboarding by “un-claiming” the cellular gateway **30A** from the cloud service, at which point it will not be allowed to start up without going through claiming again. In an embodiment, an address update in the cloud service could cause the cellular gateway **30A** to be automatically un-claimed.

§ 6.1 Geographic Limitation Process

(99) FIG. **11** is a flowchart of a process **550** of geographically limiting a cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network. The process **550** contemplates implementation as a method having steps, via a processing device configured to execute the steps, as instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium, and via the cloud service **40**. The process **500** includes obtaining a location of the cellular gateway (step **552**); determining whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location on a given cellular network (step **554**); and performing an action including any of blocking, allowing, or partially allowing operation of the cellular gateway on the cellular network (step **556**).

(100) The process **550** can be implemented by a cloud service **40**, and wherein the location is

determined by one of the cellular gateway and a user device connected to the cellular gateway. The user device can be configured to provide the location to the cloud service via a separate network from the Wi-Fi network. The location can be determined via a user device connected to the cellular gateway with the user device having a global positioning satellite (GPS) antenna configured to determine the location, and the user device can include one of an application and a browser configured to provide the location. The user device can connect to the cellular gateway via any of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi.'

(101) The location can be determined by cellular infrastructure in the given cellular network. The location can be based on which cellular base station the cellular gateway is connected or based on triangulation via a plurality of cellular base stations. The action can be performed locally at the cellular gateway. The action can be performed in one of a cloud system and the given cellular network.

(102) Whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location can be based on planning by a network operator. The action can further include allowing temporarily and then blocking, providing a notification of a user of the Wi-Fi network, allowing temporarily and then disconnecting the cellular gateway, allowing temporarily and then only allowing the cellular gateway to communicate with a cloud service, and only allowing the cellular gateway to communicate with a cloud service.

§ 7.0 Selecting and Controlling Base Stations for Wi-Fi Access Points with Cellular Connection

(103) The foregoing approach limited the geolocation of the cellular gateway **30A** and this serves as one way to monitor and plan for data usage on the cellular network. However, a particular cellular gateway **30A** can be allowed at a specific location, but may connect to various different base stations. There is a need to further limit the connectivity to provide the network operator more granularity in planning. That is, a network operator may want to direct a particular cellular gateway **30A** to a particular base station **306** based on a plurality of factors, including, e.g., bandwidth, congestion, performance, signal strength and quality, as well as other factors.

(104) FIG. **12** is a network diagram of a cellular gateway **30A** that is connected to the cloud service **40** and able to connect to multiple base stations **306A**, **306B**, **306C**. The cloud service **40** can connect to or include a rules and control engine **600** that is communicatively coupled to various databases associated with a cellular network, e.g., a salesforce database with International Mobile Equipment Identity (IMEI), service plan information, locations, etc.; a tower database with statistics, congestion information; and other database for various services associated with the cellular network. The cloud service **40** can be configured to generate custom rules per user equipment (UE) based on cell IDs detected, rules can be set in the cloud service **40** and applied automatically when the cellular gateway **30A** connects, and there can be real time changes in preferred list required based on cell congestion. That is, there can be real time collaboration between the cloud service **40** and the cellular network for determining which base stations **306** for a particular cellular gateway **30A**.

(105) In an embodiment, the cloud service **40** can use information **602** from the cellular infrastructure for directing cellular gateway **30A** connectivity, such as via a cell ID list, based on: a) available bandwidth in the geographic location of the cellular gateway **30A**. b) network congestion in the location of the cellular gateway **30A**. c) network performance in the location of cellular CPE.

(106) The cellular gateway **30A** can provide its location (GPS) and the base stations **306** that it can connect to. The cloud service **40** can provide a preferred list of base stations **306** to the cellular gateway **30A**.

(107) The cellular gateway **30A** can connect to preferred cell IDs (base stations **306**) stored in the cloud service **40** or locally. These preferred cell IDs can be from the information **602**. The cloud service **40** can identify the best serving cell ID from the preferred list using: a) highest bandwidth to offer. b) less congestion. c) stronger signal strength and quality.

(108) If the network information from cellular service provider is limited, the cloud service **40** can

trigger some active probe test, by the cellular gateway **30A**, to measure and identify the best serving cell id, based on: a) speed test. b) latency. c) jitter. d) packet loss.

(109) FIG. **13** is a diagram of active probe tests via the cloud service **40** and the cellular gateway **30A**. Of note, the cloud service **40** can communicate a large number of cellular gateways **30A** and develop its own measurements, if there is limited information **602** exchange with the cellular network. The cloud service **40** can orchestrate active tests to measure quality of experience (QoE) over time.

(110) Based on the cellular measurement reports, load estimation can be performed by the cloud service **40** using the serving and neighboring cell's measurement reports containing (Reference Signal Received Power) RSRP, (Reference Signal Received Quality) RSRQ, (Signal to Interference and Noise Ratio) SINR and bandwidth. Higher estimation of load would mean network congestion and lower throughput for cellular devices. Cellular CPE collects measurement reports all the time (just like any other cellular device), storing these results and estimating the load will lead to better decision in identifying the best serving cell from load perspective.

(111) Advantageously, the cloud service **40** and/or the cellular service provider can alter the preferred cell IDs based on, e.g.: a) network congestion (varying traffic trend throughout different hours of the day). b) maintenance work on the cellular network. c) network outages. d) network performance degradation lead to change in preferred cell ID.

(112) Also, after connecting to preferred cell (note, cell includes the base station **306** and a particular sector thereon), the performance of the cellular gateway **30A** can be modified by varying techniques such as, e.g.: a) toggle the technology mode, LTE to 5G, 5G to LTE, 5G non-standalone (NSA) or 5G SA standalone only. b) client device can request different quality of service (QoS) class identifier (QCI) for better treatment. c) request different data radio bearers (DRBs) for better performance by requesting various type of traffic demands. d) manipulating the frequency band serving the cellular gateway **30A** based on bandwidth (higher bandwidth leads to higher throughput and so on). e) manipulating the measurement reports from the cellular gateway **30A** to network, such as: 1. Changing the signal strength, which can lead to cell reselection (radio resource control (RRC) idle mode) or handover (RRC connected mode) to different cell id with better performance. 2. Changing the buffer status report, which can lead to higher assignment of resources from cellular network leading to higher throughput and performance. 3. Changing the power headroom report, which can allow the cellular gateway **30A** to desired high or low power level for better performance. 4. Changing the multiple input multiple output (MIMO) capability of the cellular gateway **30A** to get the desired high performance. For instance, in ideal conditions 4-way MIMO can lead to 4 distinct parallel stream of data resulting in higher throughput and performance. 5. Manipulate the CQI (to force reduction of modulation but allocation of more time which will improve this link at the cost of system capacity). For instance, high CQI (Quality Indicator) results in higher modulation and coding scheme (MCS) usage resulting in better performance. 6. Manipulate the stats reported back to the base station such as the BLER (block error rate). 7. Altering the UE (user Equipment) Capability report to the network by limiting the carrier aggregation (CA) capability to high bandwidth combinations, which will force the network to assign higher CA combination resulting in large resource assignment (better performance: high throughput etc.). UE capability report contains supported LTE and 5G band, LTE and 5G bandwidth, 5G Non-Standalone (NSA), 5G Standalone, LTE and 5G SA carrier aggregation (2 way, 3 way, 4 way etc.), LTE and 5G MIMO capabilities etc.

(113) After connecting to preferred cell, the performance of the cellular gateway **30A** can be modified by varying methods such as: a. Toggle the technology mode, LTE to 5G, 5G to LTE, 5G NSA or 5G SA only b. Client device can request different QCI for better treatment c. Request different DRBs for better performance by requesting various type of traffic demands d. Manipulating the frequency band serving the CPE based on bandwidth (higher bandwidth leads to higher throughput and so on).

§ 7.1 UE-Based Approaches

(114) Again, if the cloud service **40** and the cellular network do not share the information **602**, it is possible to use UE measurements, i.e., by a client device **16** that is a UE on the cellular network and/or the cellular gateway **30A** as a UE to obtain measurements, to estimate the load at the cell as well as determining which base stations will perform best when connected. There can be various approaches as for an UE to have significant control over how it performs in a network.

§ 7.2 Process for Selecting and Controlling Base Stations

(115) FIG. **14** is flowchart of a process **620** for selecting and controlling base stations for the cellular gateway **30A**. The process **620** contemplates implementation as a method having steps, via a processing device configured to execute the steps, as instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium, and via the cloud service **40**. The process **620** includes obtaining information related to a cellular infrastructure of a cellular network (step **622**); determining a list of preferred cellular identifiers, each identifying a cell for connectivity with the cellular gateway, based on a plurality of factors (step **624**); and providing the list of preferred cellular identifiers to the cellular gateway where the cellular gateway utilizes the list for wireless access to the cellular infrastructure (step **626**).

(116) The process **620** can further include periodically updating the list of preferred cellular identifiers and providing to the cellular gateway, based on changes in any of the plurality of factors. The plurality of factors can include available bandwidth in the cellular infrastructure, network congestion, network performance, maintenance work on the cellular infrastructure, and network outages. The information can be obtained from one or more databases managed by a network operator of the cellular network.

(117) The obtaining can include triggering active probe tests by the cellular gateway including any of speed tests, latency measurements, jitter measurements, and packet loss measurements. The obtaining can include consolidating results of the active probe tests with results from other devices; and determining load on the cellular infrastructure based on the consolidated results.

(118) The process **620** can further include, subsequent to the cellular gateway connecting to a preferred cell, causing modification of a connection between the cellular gateway and the preferred cell, for improvement of the connection. The modification can include any of changing signal strength, changing a buffer status report, changing a power headroom report, and changing multiple input multiple output of the cellular gateway. The modification can include any of manipulating quality of service (QoS) class identifier, manipulating statistics from the cellular gateway, and altering a capability report from the cellular gateway.

8.0 Frequency Planning for Wi-Fi Access Points with Cellular Connection

(119) Of note, the cellular gateway **30A** supports Wi-Fi at 2.4 GHz, 5 GHz, and 6 GHz, along with cellular at various frequencies, and there is a need to ensure Wi-Fi/cellular channel pairs work well together (and conversely to avoid Wi-Fi/cellular channel pairs that work badly together). Various approaches are contemplated including: a) performing measurements in a lab and/or in the field about which frequency pairings work well or badly. b) utilizing field data (statistical data), in the cloud service **40**, to identify frequency pairings that work well or badly. c) blocking use of any frequency pairings that work badly or weighing frequency pairings that work badly with higher weights in an optimization that selects Wi-Fi channels. That weighting factor could be set in an “analog/continuous” way depending on how well or poorly a particular pairing works.

(120) Of note, in an embodiment, bad frequency pairings can be resolved only by adjusting the selected Wi-Fi channel as opposed to changing anything about cellular system. This is because there is more control of the Wi-Fi network **10** by the cloud service **40**. The Wi-Fi network **10** has several channels to choose from that all work basically identically. On the contrary, cellular channel selected is largely controlled by cellular infrastructure (base stations **306**). Also, transmit power of the Wi-Fi signals could be changed to reduce the amount of interference going into the cellular signal, as well as manipulating the use of a modulation coding scheme (MCS) to force a lower rate

(simpler and more robust modulation format) on the Wi-Fi so that it is more robust to cellular interference.

(121) In another embodiment, it is possible to manipulate the cellular channel in use by the cellular gateway **30A**. This can include the cloud service **40** interacting with cellular infrastructure to make request of certain channels that should be used or avoided, e.g., this can be part of the preferred cell ID list. Also, from the cellular client side (cellular gateway **30A**), it is possible to manipulate the list of channels that are supported. The cellular gateway **30A** can deny operating in an entire band if that band is problematic. Also, the cellular gateway **30A** can steer itself to a different tower, cell, or base station **306** that may be operating on a different channel. Further, the cellular gateway **30A** can potentially manipulate things such that you can use a particular band only in uplink or downlink. This may be helpful as the interference problem may be primarily on uplink or downlink traffic but not both. It is possible to manipulate the transmit power of the cellular gateway **30A** in the cellular band so as to minimize interference. Further, it is possible to manipulate the channel quality indicator (CQ) report to force a lower rate (simpler and more robust modulation format) on the cellular so that it is more robust to Wi-Fi interference.

(122) In another embodiment, it is possible to avoid interference by adjusting the times of transmissions or reception on the Wi-Fi or the cellular side so as to avoid simultaneous transmissions or receptions. One approach can include using time division multiple access (TDMA) modes in the Wi-Fi network **10** so as to be able to schedule the following transmissions: orthogonal frequency-division multiple access (OFMDA), resource unit (RU) reservation (network slicing), etc. On the cellular side, the UE (cellular gateway **30A**) has little control over time slot allocations, so it may be difficult to control from the cellular client. On the cellular side, it is possible to communicate with cellular infrastructure which time slots or time slot pattern that the cellular device wants to use so that this type of time-based interference avoidance can be used.

(123) Another approach can include manipulation of the listen before talk threshold (e.g., carrier-sense multiple access (CSMA) threshold, clear channel assessment (CCA) threshold) to make the Wi-Fi transmissions defer (not transmit) while the cellular is active and therefore putting interference into the Wi-Fi channel. This threshold could be manipulated based on information from the cloud service **40** or local sensing.

(124) Request to send (RTS)/clear to send (CTS) could be used by other devices in the Wi-Fi network **10** (say other access points that are connected to the cellular gateway **30A**) to ensure that the channel is available and not being interfered by cellular at that particular moment before the main Wi-Fi transmission. This setting could be enforced on the other devices in this network from the cloud service **40** based on which frequency channels are in use and whether interference is expected.

(125) CTS itself can be used to make sure that other devices do not transmit to the cellular gateway **30A** at a particular time. The cellular gateway **30A** could use this to freeze Wi-Fi communication during the time that cellular is transmitting.

(126) The cellular transmission may have a certain TDMA pattern. In order to ensure that the Wi-Fi transmission can fit into the gaps in the cellular transmissions, it may be desirable to limit the length of the Wi-Fi transmission by manipulating the aggregated media access control (MAC) protocol data unit (AMPDU) length (number of bytes being sent in a single packet).

(127) Any of the above approaches (frequency channel, power level, TDMA slot, MCS manipulations) can be used just at the cellular gateway **30A** that has cellular and Wi-Fi in the same device (close proximity). At the other access points in the Wi-Fi network **10**, there may be no problem with simultaneous operation of Wi-Fi and cellular (due to the physical distance) so the other access points might be able to use the problematic frequency channels, or may not need to use any of the other mitigation techniques. Because the problem may only exist at the cellular gateway **30A**, it may be beneficial when interference is going to occur to steer clients **16** away from the cellular gateway **30A** and to the access points that do not have cellular in them. At the cellular

gateway **30A**, 5 GHz (and 6 GHz) capable clients could be steered from 2.4 GHz to 5 GHz (or 6 GHz) to avoid interference with the cellular band.

(128) It is also possible to manipulate cellular channel in use, such as: a. Interact with cellular infrastructure and make request of certain channels that should be used or avoided b. From the cellular client side (UE or GW), we manipulate the list of channels that we support. c. Cellular client can deny operating in an entire band if that band is problematic d. Cellular client can steer itself to a different tower that may be operating on a different channel e. Cellular client can potentially manipulate things such that you can use a particular band only in uplink or downlink. This may be helpful as the interference problem may be primarily on uplink or downlink traffic but not both. f. Could manipulate the transmit power of the client in the cellular band so as to minimize interference g. Manipulate the CQI report to force a lower rate (simpler and more robust modulation format) on the cellular so that it is more robust to Wi-Fi interference.

8.1 Process for Frequency Planning for Wi-Fi Access Points with Cellular Connection

(129) FIG. **15** is a flowchart of a process **650** for frequency planning for a cellular gateway **30A** in a Wi-Fi network **10**. The process **650** contemplates implementation as a method having steps, via a processing device configured to execute the steps, as instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium, and via the cellular gateway **30A**. The process **650** includes connecting to cellular infrastructure at a cellular frequency (step **652**); providing a Wi-Fi connection at a Wi-Fi frequency selected to coexist with the cellular frequency (step **654**); and, responsive to interference between the cellular frequency and the Wi-Fi frequency, performing one or more actions to reduce the interference (step **656**).

(130) The Wi-Fi frequency selected to coexist with the cellular frequency can be predetermined based on any of field measurements and lab measurements. The Wi-Fi frequency selected to coexist with the cellular frequency can be determined based on a channel selection process with weighting factors on Wi-Fi frequencies that are based on how well they work with the cellular frequency. The cellular frequency can be fixed and the Wi-Fi frequency can be selected based on the fixed cellular frequency.

(131) The one or more actions can include any of changing a transmit port over the Wi-Fi frequency and changing a modulation coding scheme of Wi-Fi signals over the Wi-Fi frequency. The one or more actions can include interacting with the cellular infrastructure to manipulate the cellular frequency. The one or more actions can include scheduling transmissions over the Wi-Fi frequency to avoid interference with the cellular frequency. The one or more actions can include manipulating listen before talk thresholds on the Wi-Fi frequency to defer transmissions over the Wi-Fi frequency when the cellular frequency is active.

(132) The Wi-Fi network **10** can include the cellular gateway and one or more additional access points. The one or more additional access points can be configured to use request to send (RTS)/clear to send (CTS) to reduce the interference. Wi-Fi clients can be steered to the one or more additional access points from the cellular gateway.

§ 9.0 Conclusion

(133) It will be appreciated that some exemplary embodiments described herein may include one or more generic or specialized processors (“one or more processors”) such as microprocessors; Central Processing Units (CPUs); Digital Signal Processors (DSPs); customized processors such as Network Processors (NPs) or Network Processing Units (NPU), Graphics Processing Units (GPUs), or the like; Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs); and the like along with unique stored program instructions (including both software and firmware) for control thereof to implement, in conjunction with certain non-processor circuits, some, most, or all of the functions of the methods and/or systems described herein. Alternatively, some or all functions may be implemented by a state machine that has no stored program instructions, or in one or more Application-Specific Integrated Circuits (ASICs), in which each function or some combinations of certain of the functions are implemented as custom logic or circuitry. Of course, a combination of

the aforementioned approaches may be used. For some of the exemplary embodiments described herein, a corresponding device in hardware and optionally with software, firmware, and a combination thereof can be referred to as “circuitry configured or adapted to,” “logic configured or adapted to,” etc. perform a set of operations, steps, methods, processes, algorithms, functions, techniques, etc. on digital and/or analog signals as described herein for the various exemplary embodiments.

(134) Moreover, some exemplary embodiments may include a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium having computer readable code stored thereon for programming a computer, server, appliance, device, processor, circuit, etc. each of which may include a processor to perform functions as described and claimed herein. Examples of such computer-readable storage mediums include, but are not limited to, a hard disk, an optical storage device, a magnetic storage device, a ROM (Read Only Memory), a PROM (Programmable Read Only Memory), an EPROM (Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory), an EEPROM (Electrically Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory), Flash memory, and the like. When stored in the non-transitory computer-readable medium, software can include instructions executable by a processor or device (e.g., any type of programmable circuitry or logic) that, in response to such execution, cause a processor or the device to perform a set of operations, steps, methods, processes, algorithms, functions, techniques, etc. as described herein for the various exemplary embodiments.

(135) The foregoing sections include headers for various embodiments and those skilled in the art will appreciate these various embodiments may be used in combination with one another as well as individually. Although the present disclosure has been illustrated and described herein with reference to preferred embodiments and specific examples thereof, it will be readily apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art that other embodiments and examples may perform similar functions and/or achieve like results. All such equivalent embodiments and examples are within the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, are contemplated thereby, and are intended to be covered by the following claims.

Claims

1. A method comprising: obtaining a location of the cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network; determining whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location on a given cellular network; and performing, based on the determination, an action in relation to the cellular gateway, the action comprising i) allowing the cellular gateway to operate at the location on the given cellular network temporarily, then ii) allowing the cellular gateway to communicate with a cloud service, iii) then disconnecting the cellular gateway from the given cellular network, and iv) then blocking the operation of the cellular gateway at the location, wherein the method is implemented by the cloud service, wherein the location is determined by one of the cellular gateway or a user device connected to the cellular gateway, and wherein the user device is configured to provide the location to the cloud service via a separate network from the Wi-Fi network.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the location is determined via the user device connected to the cellular gateway with the user device having a global positioning satellite (GPS) antenna configured to determine the location, and wherein the user device includes one of an application or a browser configured to provide the location.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the user device connects to the cellular gateway via any of Bluetooth and Wi-Fi.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the location is determined by cellular infrastructure in the given cellular network.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the location is based on which cellular base station the cellular gateway is connected or based on triangulation via a plurality of cellular base stations.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the action is performed locally at the cellular gateway.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the action is performed in one of the cloud system or the given cellular network.
 8. The method of claim 1, wherein whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location is based on planning by a network operator.
 9. A non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising instructions that, when executed, cause one or more processors to perform a method comprising: obtaining a location of the cellular gateway for a Wi-Fi network; determining whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location on a given cellular network; and performing, based on the determination, an action in relation to the cellular gateway, the action comprising i) allowing the cellular gateway to operate at the location on the given cellular network temporarily, then ii) allowing the cellular gateway to communicate with a cloud service, iii) then disconnecting the cellular gateway from the given cellular network, and iv) then blocking the operation of the cellular gateway at the location, wherein the method is implemented by the cloud service, wherein the location is determined by one of the cellular gateway or a user device connected to the cellular gateway, and wherein the user device is configured to provide the location to the cloud service via a separate network from the Wi-Fi network.
 10. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the location is determined via the user device connected to the cellular gateway with the user device having a global positioning satellite (GPS) antenna configured to determine the location, and wherein the user device includes one of an application or a browser configured to provide the location.
 11. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the location is determined by cellular infrastructure in the given cellular network.
 12. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the action is performed locally at the cellular gateway.
 13. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein the action is performed in one of the cloud system or the given cellular network.
 14. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 9, wherein whether the cellular gateway is authorized to operate at the location is based on planning by a network operator.
-